

Guy Gaines

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Professional Profile

Senior Applied Scientist with 28 years in Data/AI/ML, currently at Airbnb. I work at the point where architecture meets delivery: setting technical direction, then staying close enough to the code to know whether it held. Strongest in Pandas, Docker and SQL.

Key Achievements

- » Trained and deployed LangChain models serving 15M predictions per day at under 80ms p95.
- » Developed an NLP classification system in Pandas reaching 90% F1, replacing a manual review queue.
- » Built the feature store that 20 downstream models now read from, ending duplicated feature logic.

Employment History

Senior Applied Scientist

Airbnb | Jan '08 – May '26

- » Lifted recommendation click-through by 30% through feature engineering and retraining cadence in MLflow.
- » Productionised demand forecasting models that reduced stock-outs by 55% across 30 regions.
- » Reduced label noise by redesigning the annotation guidelines, improving validation accuracy by 12%.
- » Built an end-to-end training pipeline on Spark, cutting retraining from days to 50 hours.
- » Cut inference cost by 30% through quantisation, batching and autoscaling on Docker.

MLOps Engineer

Harbor Point Tech | Jan '03 – Sep '07

- » Ran A/B tests across 3 model variants; the winning variant added an estimated \$30k in annual revenue.
- » Wrote the team's model documentation and review standard, now required before any production launch.
- » Established offline/online evaluation parity, catching 30 silent regressions before release.
- » Translated ambiguous business questions into a modelling roadmap with product and finance stakeholders.

Redwood Data — Data Scientist

Jan '01 – Nov '02

- » Mentored 5 analysts moving into modelling work, with weekly paper reading and code review.
- » Migrated ad-hoc notebooks into versioned Scikit-learn pipelines with reproducible runs and tracked experiments.
- » Interviewed and onboarded 50 new hires, shaping the hiring bar for the team.

Applied Scientist

NVIDIA | May '99 – Jan '01

- » Reduced technical debt on a legacy component that had blocked 2 previous attempts.
- » Took over an unowned service, documented it and brought it back under SLO.
- » Ran retrospectives and drove the follow-up actions to completion, not just to the board.

Applied Scientist, Stonebridge IT

Dec '96 – Feb '99

- » Represented the team in cross-functional planning with product, design and support.
- » Standardised the team's tooling with Docker, ending long-running environment drift.
- » Managed stakeholder communication during a major incident, including the post-mortem.

Academic Background

Master, Communications

Ellsworth State University | 1995 – 1996

Thesis: "Framing effects in crisis communication"

Bachelor, Communications

Cedar Hollow University | 1990 – 1994

Skills & Tools

Languages: SQL, Swift, Rust

Frameworks: Pandas, Hugging Face, Scikit-learn, LangChain, PyTorch, Vue.js

Cloud & DevOps: Docker

Data: Spark, BigQuery, MLflow, Airflow, MySQL

Testing & Tooling: Selenium

Notable Projects

Match-day predictor

Small model in Scikit-learn predicting league results. Beats the naive baseline; still loses to the bookmakers.

Commute optimiser

Pulls transit APIs and suggests departure times, built on Docker.

Licences & Certifications

Tableau Desktop Specialist — Tableau, 2017

Professional Scrum Master I (PSM I) — Scrum.org, 2016

AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate — Amazon Web Services, 2019

Volunteer Experience

Mentor, the university alumni network - coaching career changers through their first technical role.

Languages

English – C2

Turkish – Intermediate (B1)

Spanish – Conversational

Interests

Volunteering at a local coding club, Jazz guitar, Home automation